



SQL CLASS NOTE – MODULE 5: DISTINCT

1. Introduction

The **DISTINCT** keyword is used to remove duplicate values from the result of a query.

- Without **DISTINCT** : SQL shows **all rows**, including duplicates.
- With **DISTINCT** : SQL shows **only unique values**.

👉 Think of it as asking:

- *“Give me a list of all grade levels in the school.”*
- Without **DISTINCT** , you might see **Grade 10** repeated 50 times.
- With **DISTINCT** , you see **Grade 10** only once.

2. Syntax

```
SELECT DISTINCT column1, column2, ...  
FROM table_name;
```

- Applies to the **entire row of selected columns**.
- If you use multiple columns, **DISTINCT** ensures uniqueness across the **combination** of those columns.

3. Practical Examples with `SchoolDB`

Example 1: Get all unique grade levels

```
SELECT DISTINCT GradeLevel  
FROM Students;
```

✦ Removes duplicates — each grade shows only once.

Example 2: Get unique course teachers

```
SELECT DISTINCT Teacher  
FROM Courses;
```

✦ If multiple courses are taught by the same teacher, they appear only once.

Example 3: Unique combinations of GradeLevel and Gender

```
SELECT DISTINCT GradeLevel, Gender  
FROM Students;
```

✦ Returns combinations like:

- Grade 9 – Male
- Grade 9 – Female
- Grade 10 – Male
- Grade 10 – Female

Example 4: Unique student-course pairs from enrollments

```
SELECT DISTINCT StudentID, CourseID  
FROM Enrollments;
```

✦ Ensures you don't see duplicate enrollments of the same student in the same course.

Example 5: Count distinct grade levels

```
SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT GradeLevel) AS UniqueGrades  
FROM Students;
```

✦ Tells you how many different grade levels exist in the database.

4. Why Use DISTINCT ?

- To avoid **repetition** in reports.
- To summarize data efficiently.
- To get a **clear picture** of all possible values without duplicates.

5. Real-Life Use Cases

- **Schools**: Get a list of all unique grade levels or class sections.
- **Banks**: Find unique types of transactions (Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer).
- **Hospitals**: Show all unique diagnoses.
- **E-commerce**: List unique product categories.

6. Classwork (Practice)

👉 Try these queries on **SchoolDB**:

1. Get all unique grade levels from the **Students** table.
2. Show all unique teachers from the **Courses** table.
3. Get all unique genders from the **Students** table.
4. List unique combinations of `GradeLevel` and `Gender` .
5. Find the number of unique courses offered.
6. Show all distinct enrollment dates from the **Enrollments** table.
7. List all unique first names of students.

7. Challenge Question

👉 Write a query to display all unique combinations of `GradeLevel` and `CourseID` from **Enrollments** — this will show which grade levels are enrolled in which courses (without duplication).

✅ That's the **expanded Module 5: DISTINCT** .

Perfect 👍 Let's solve the **Module 5 Classwork + Challenge** step by step with real SQL queries.



Solutions to Module 5: DISTINCT

1. Get all unique grade levels from the **Students** table.

```
SELECT DISTINCT GradeLevel  
FROM Students;
```

2. Show all unique teachers from the **Courses** table.

```
SELECT DISTINCT Teacher  
FROM Courses;
```

3. Get all unique genders from the **Students** table.

```
SELECT DISTINCT Gender  
FROM Students;
```

4. List unique combinations of **GradeLevel** and **Gender** .

```
SELECT DISTINCT GradeLevel, Gender  
FROM Students;
```

5. Find the number of unique courses offered.

```
SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT CourseName) AS UniqueCourses
FROM Courses;
```

6. Show all distinct enrollment dates from the **Enrollments** table.

```
SELECT DISTINCT EnrollmentDate
FROM Enrollments;
```

7. List all unique first names of students.

```
SELECT DISTINCT FirstName
FROM Students;
```



Challenge Question

👉 Display all unique combinations of `GradeLevel` and `CourseID` from **Enrollments**.

```
SELECT DISTINCT s.GradeLevel, e.CourseID
FROM Enrollments e
JOIN Students s ON e.StudentID = s.StudentID
ORDER BY s.GradeLevel ASC, e.CourseID ASC;
```

✳️ This shows which grade levels are enrolled in which courses **without duplicates**.

✅ That completes **Module 5: DISTINCT**.

👉 Shall we continue with **Module 6: ALIAS (as)** in the same expanded style (definitions, examples, classwork, and challenge)?